

from within an organisation. The organisation could be either a private or public (government) one. On the other hand, a journalist is a person who collects, writes and distributes news, either through the means of formal or informal journalism, even blogging.

Sometimes, these two need to communicate safely and in privacy. When the identity of the whistleblower gets leaked, it can become risky for him or her. Think of an Edward Snowden or a Chelsea Manning. Hence, the communication needs to be done in a very secure environment.

That's where SecureDrop comes in. "The [FOSS] program helps a whistleblower to release information to a journalist. If you get caught releasing information, you could be thrown into jail. Or, you could get killed. Whistleblowers take a lot of risks. They realise that something pretty bad is going on, and then they step up to release the information," says Kushal Das. Incidentally, some lists show India among the top ten most dangerous countries for journalists, globally.

SecureDrop is actually a Web application. It can be deployed by big media organisations, small media outfits or even by an individual journalist — on their own server, inside their own office.

KUSHAL(7)	Linux User's Manual	KUSHAL(7)
NAME		
Kushal Das - building communities and sometimes software		
SYNOPSIS		
kushal [--public-interest-technologist] [--contributor] [--securedrop] [--tor] [--python]		
SUMMARY		
Public interest technologist at Freedom of the Press Foundation. Spending life helping various FOSS projects and communities in different roles. Part of the Tor Project Core team. and also a core developer of CPython, and director at Python Software Foundation. In 2004 I founded dgplug and still help there as a co-ordinator. I spend a lot of time with new contributors in #dgplug channel on freednode.		
SEE ALSO		
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Kushal Das	2019-05-18	KUSHAL(7)
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Figure 1: User manual

"We provide certain suggestions on what kinds of servers could be used — right now we suggest two Mac minis. If you open *The Washington Post*, *The New York Times* or *The Intercept* online, you can open SecureDrop on the site, using a Tor browser," Das says. Tor incidentally is FOSS software that is used to enable anonymous and secure Internet access.

If you're a first time user, you can visit a news website you trust and submit a document. Later, you might plan to return to the site, to check if a response has been given to your submission.

Das adds, "We do not have a password based system; instead there is a passphrase. If you're coming in only once, to submit documents and go away, you don't have to remember this. If you're returning, we suggest you write down the passphrase, memorise it, and then destroy the paper. We provide a guide on how to leak: don't do it from your office network. Preferably buy a second-hand computer, or go to a public cafe where others are browsing, and make sure your screen is not visible from anywhere else. And then don't



SecureDrop is a project of Freedom of the Press Foundation

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SecureDrop release signing key (not for communication)

2224 5C81 E3BA EB41 38B3 6061 310F 5612 00F4 AD77

Tor address

secdrop5wyphb5x.onion

Figure 2: SecureDrop